



Plants for cool colors

Ever since Vita Sackville West created her famous white garden in the 1930s, designers have raved about the beauty of monochrome planting schemes.

To achieve a similar effect, plant a succession of white flowers, starting in spring with hellebores and snowdrops, peaking in summer with peonies, roses, and shasta daisies, and concluding in fall with asters and Japanese anemones. If you find an all-white scheme too restrictive, include a few blues, which will blend well without jarring the overall effect. You can also create a cool, neutral backdrop for pastel or brightly colored flowers with blue and gray foliage, or use silver-leaved plants, such as wormwood, dusty miller, and lamb's ears, to reflect the sun and twinkle from beds like spotlights.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Agapanthus africanus

AFRICAN LILY This evergreen perennial has strap-shaped leaves and spherical heads of deep blue trumpet-shaped flowers on sturdy unbranched stems during summer. Suitable for mixed or single plantings. Provide protection from cold temperatures.

↑3ft (1m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ Z8–10



PERENNIAL LARGE

Anemone x hybrida

JAPANESE ANEMONE This upright, slowly spreading, clump-forming perennial has lobed leaves. With its spherical buds and pink or white, saucer-shaped single or semidouble blooms, it makes a lovely feature in late summer beds.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ Z4–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aquilegia vulgaris

COLUMBINE This upright clump-forming perennial has ferny foliage. From late spring to early summer, it bears nodding flowers with spurred petals in mainly pastel shades in violet, blue, and pink, as well as white.

↑3ft (1m) ↔18in (45cm)

☀️ Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Artemisia ludoviciana 'Silver Queen'

WESTERN MUGWORT Grown as a foil for flowers, this spreading perennial has narrow silver-gray leaves on upright stems. Remove the small yellow summer blooms to maintain the foliage effect. May spread aggressively.

↑↔30in (75cm)

☀️ Z4–9 (N)



TREE LARGE

Abies concolor

WHITE FIR An evergreen conifer with an attractive "Christmas tree" shape. It makes a good lawn specimen and can be a feature in a mixed boundary scheme. The silver-gray needles are its main feature. Prune carefully, if required.

↑130ft (40m) ↔22ft (7m)

☀️ Z3–7 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aconitum 'Stainless Steel'

MONKSHOOD This perennial makes a substantial clump of deeply divided leaves. Its mid- to late summer spires of unusual hooded silvery blue blooms create an elegant impression within a shaded bed. All parts are poisonous.

↑3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Anthemis punctata subsp. *cupaniana*

SICILIAN CHAMOMILE This carpeting evergreen perennial has filigree silver foliage that turns green in winter. It bears a mass of yellow-centered white daisies with a single bloom on each short stem in early summer.

↑↔12in (30cm)

☀️ Z6–9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aster ericoides

Renamed *Symphyotrichum ericoides* Plant this clump-forming heath aster mid-bed with small-leaved fall-interest plants. Sprays of tiny white daisies are borne for weeks and make an excellent foil for larger, more solid blooms and leaves.

↑3ft (1m) ↔12in (30cm)

☀️ Z5–8 (N)



SHRUB SMALL

Artemisia 'Powis Castle'

WORMWOOD A semievergreen subshrub with fernlike silvery gray leaves that provide a foil for green-leaved plants, including roses and sun-loving border perennials. Snip off the yellow pompomlike flowers to enhance the effect.

↑↔3ft (1m)

☀️ Z7–9